
Paper 1, Option 1C:

Britain, 1625–1701: conflict, revolution and settlement

Overview

This option comprises a study in breadth, in which students will learn about key features of monarchical and republican rule in Britain in the seventeenth century, set within the context of broader social, economic and religious change. The events of this period saw a decisive shift in the balance of power between crown and parliament.

The focus of study is on developments and changes over a broad timescale and so the content is presented as themes spanning a significant duration: 1625–88. This option also contains a study in depth of historical interpretations on a broad question that is contextualised by, and runs on from, the themes: how revolutionary, in the years to 1701, was the Glorious Revolution of 1688–89?

Themes	Content
1 The quest for political stability, 1625–88	• The failure of monarchical government, 1625–46: Charles I and parliament, 1625–29; personal rule and its failure, 1629–40 and the failure to compromise, 1640–49. • Republican rule, 1649–60: reasons for the failure of Republican attempts to provide stable government; the role of Cromwell. • From restoration to revolution, 1660–88: the Restoration Settlement, 1660–64; conflicts between king and parliaments, 1665–81; personal rule and the collapse of royal power, 1681–88.
2 Religion: conflict and dissent, 1625–88	• The Church of England: Laud's policies and religious uniformity; parliament's reordering of the church, 1640–60; the restoration of Anglicanism, 1660–62 and its dominant position in religious life. • The growth of religious nonconformity: Puritanism under Charles I; Presbyterians and religious radicalism; the persecution of dissenters under Charles II and James II. • The Catholic question: Catholic influence within Charles I's court; the exclusion of Catholics from religious toleration; anti-Catholic sentiment, 1660–88.

Themes	Content
3 Social and intellectual challenge, 1625–88	- Population: reasons for the increase in population; the impact of population growth on urban development and rural change; growth of poverty; the Poor Laws and actions against beggars and vagrants. - The changing structure of society: the power of the nobility; the changing gentry class; urbanisation and the growth of the professional and merchant classes; the impact of religious and legal changes on the status of women. - A ferment of ideas: radical political ideas, including the Levellers and the Diggers; the end of divine right monarchy and a confessional state; the significance of the ideas of Hobbes and Locke; the scientific revolution, including Francis Bacon and the experimental method; the significance of the Royal Society.
4 Economy, trade and empire, 1625–88	- Agriculture: changes in agricultural techniques; the development of specialised farming and the growth of employment; capital investment in agriculture; the development of national markets. - Changing domestic trade patterns: the changing cloth trade, including 'new draperies' and the impact of Protestant refugees; the growth of London and its impact on economic development; the growth of banking and insurance. - The impact of imperial expansion: the significance of North America and Jamaica; the Navigation Acts and the development of mercantilism; effects of Anglo-Dutch commercial rivalry; the role of the East India Company; the significance of British control of the triangular trade. Changing trading patterns.

Historical interpretations	Content
How revolutionary, in the years to 1701, was the Glorious Revolution of 1688–89?	- The significance of revolutionary ideals in the establishment of a constitutional monarchy. - The impact of the Toleration Act 1689 and the end of Anglican supremacy. - The significance of the Triennial Act 1694 and the growth of parliamentary power. - The importance of William III's wars in the development of a financial revolution.